

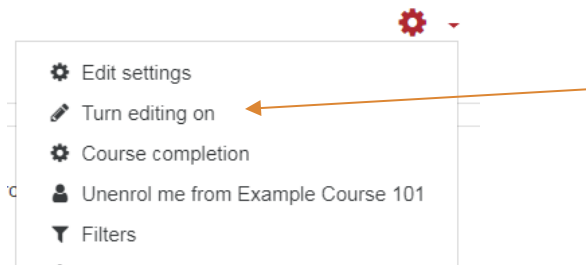
Forums

Types of Forums

1. **A single simple discussion** - A single topic discussion developed on one page, which is useful for short focused discussions (cannot be used with separate groups).
2. **Standard forum for general use** - An open forum where anyone can start a new topic at any time; this is the best general-purpose forum.
3. **Each person posts one discussion** - Each person can post exactly one new discussion topic (everyone can reply to them though); this is useful when you want each student to start a discussion about, say, their reflections on the week's topic, and everyone else responds to these.
4. **Q and A forum** - Instead of initiating, discussion participants pose a question in the initial post of a discussion. Students may reply with an answer, but they will not see the replies of other Students to the question in that discussion until they themselves have replied to the same discussion.
5. **Standard forum displayed in a blog-like format.** Makes the forum look similar to a blog, where the first post of the discussion is prominently displayed, and the replies are hidden unless you click on 'Replies'.

Adding New Forum

1. Turn on editing by clicking on the **Settings** button and selecting **Turn editing on** from the dropdown menu.



2. Click on **Add an activity or resource.**
3. Click on **Add a Forum.**

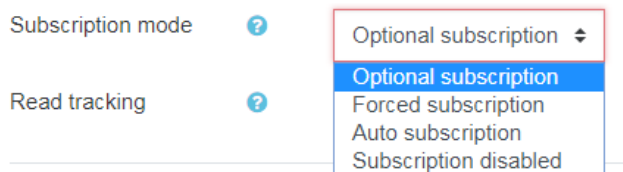
4. **Give** your Forum a Name and Description (include directions).
5. Choose what type of forum you'd like (look above for descriptions).
6. Attachments and Word Count- Are you going to allow attachments? You can determine this in this section. You can also include a word count in your forum for posts that require a minimum or maximum amount of words. This word count does not limit the number of words in a post, however.
6. Subscription mode- refers to whether or not the student will receive emails about forums.

Optional- students choose to be subscribed (by default, they are not initially subscribed to a forum with this subscription type).

Forced- students are forced to receive the emails and cannot opt out.

Auto subscription- students are subscribed to the forum, but they may opt out later.

Subscription disabled- students are not subscribed and are not allowed to subscribe.



The image shows a screenshot of the Moodle Forum settings interface. On the left, there are two labels: 'Subscription mode' and 'Read tracking', each followed by a question mark icon. To the right of 'Subscription mode' is a dropdown menu. The dropdown menu is open, showing five options: 'Optional subscription' (highlighted in blue), 'Optional subscription' (in white), 'Forced subscription', 'Auto subscription', and 'Subscription disabled'. The 'Optional subscription' option is selected.

7. Read tracking- keep track of posts you have read.
8. Post threshold for blocking allows you to set parameters around how often a student posts. For example – you can set how long a student has to wait after posting before posting again. You can also set how many posts are allowed before the student is blocked from posting again. You can also set a block warning that students will get after a certain number of posts.
9. Choose the grade category this forum belongs to (if the forum is being graded).
10. Ratings – you can set how this forum is going to be graded (note: only those with the 'Teacher' role or above can rate students' posts)

For more information, please contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca